

Perfect—this is exactly the right way to think about it: “What will it actually cost me just to test?”

Let’s break down **real Twilio costs in simple numbers** for your home services site 👉 Twilio



REAL Twilio Cost Breakdown (2026)



1. Core pricing (what you think you’ll pay)

- SMS per message: **\$0.0083 (~0.8¢)** ([apidog](#))
- Phone number: **\$1.15/month** ([apidog](#))
- No monthly subscription required

👉 Looks cheap... but that’s NOT the full picture.



2. Hidden / real costs (this is what matters)



Carrier fees (mandatory in U.S.)

- ~\$0.003 – \$0.005 per SMS ([apidog](#))

👉 So REAL cost per SMS:

- **\$0.011 – \$0.013 per text (~1.1¢–1.3¢)**
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10DLC Registration (required for business texting)

- Brand registration: ~\$4.50 one-time ([apidog](#))
- Campaign fee: **\$1.50–\$10/month** ([apidog](#))

👉 You MUST do this or messages may be blocked



Other possible costs (optional)

- Failed messages: ~\$0.001 each ([apidog](#))
 - Link tracking: ~\$0.015 per message (optional) ([apidog](#))
 - Support plan: \$0 (you don't need paid support now)
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REAL TESTING SCENARIOS (for FixitGenie)

Scenario 1 — Light testing (BEST for you now)

Let's say:

- 100 SMS total (testing forms, alerts, etc.)

Cost:

- Messages: $100 \times \$0.012 = \mathbf{\$1.20}$
- Phone number: **\$1.15**
- 10DLC: ~\$2 (monthly avg)

  **TOTAL $\approx$ \$4–\$5**

Scenario 2 — Small real usage

- 1,000 SMS/month (leads, confirmations)

Cost:

- Messages: ~\$12
- Number: \$1.15
- 10DLC: ~\$2–\$10

  **TOTAL $\approx$ \$15–\$25/month**

Scenario 3 — Growing home service platform

- 10,000 SMS/month

Cost:

- Messages: ~\$120
- Fees: ~\$40–\$50 extra
- Number + compliance: ~\$10

👉 ⚠️ **TOTAL ≈ \$160–\$180/month** ([CheckThat.ai](https://checkthat.ai))

What this means for YOUR site (FixitGenie)

Your use case:

- Lead notifications
- Booking confirmations
- Customer updates

👉 You'll likely be in:
\$5–\$20/month range while testing

My honest recommendation

✅ **Start with Twilio IF:**

- You want **fast setup**
 - You're testing product-market fit
 - You're using **Make.com** / **WordPress** / **APIs**
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⚠️ **But plan ahead:**

Once you grow:

- Twilio becomes **2–3x more expensive than alternatives**



Pro Tip (very important for you)

For your home services platform:

👉 Don't send SMS for everything
Use it only for:

- 🔔 New lead alerts
- 📅 Booking confirmations
- 📢 Urgent updates

👉 Use email for the rest (cheaper)



Bottom line

- Testing cost: **\$5–\$20/month**
 - Real cost per SMS: **~1.2¢**
 - Safe to start → **YES**
 - Best long-term → maybe switch later
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If you want next step, I can:

👉 Show you **exactly where to place SMS in your FixitGenie flow** (so you don't waste money)

👉 Or build a **cheap hybrid system (SMS + email + WhatsApp)** for you